



BEATING THE BLUES

AFTER SUFFERING FROM subdued demand and a steep rise in commodity prices for over a year, fast-moving consumer goods makers are gearing up for bumper sales during the festive season in October. From Hindustan Unilever and ITC to Nestlé, Parle Products and Mondelez, leading companies are ramping up their

procurement and production schedules in anticipation of higher sales in the coming weeks. According to them, the uptick in demand is already visible in consumers' buying patterns. That may finally bring some relief to the companies' stressed margins and lacklustre volume offtake.

—ARNAB DUTTA

DERIVATIVES IN FOCUS

At a time when retail participation in the market is increasing amidst an influx of young and first-time investors, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), the capital markets regulator, is mulling enhanced disclosures for investors in the high-risk, high-reward derivatives segment. Sebi Chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch recently said that enhanced disclosure of information is in the works, clearly hinting that it would help investors take better-informed investment decisions.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

One Satellite to Rule Them All

The IIT Madras-incubated imaging satellite operator GalaxEye has inked a memorandum of understanding with California-based satellite software provider Antaris to develop the world's first satellite containing both Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) and optical sensors. Satellite constellations deployed today capture data at different times from different locations, often resulting in consumers wasting a lot of time trying to interpret it. The new multi-sensor satellite will capture both SAR and optical data to improve correlation and analytical utility. Expected to be launched in late



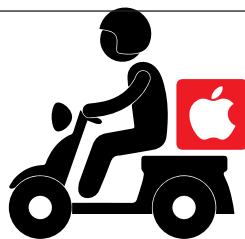
2023, the datasets delivered by the satellite will especially be of immense value to environmental, insurance and defence applications.

—MANISH PANT

18 |

₹4.45

**LAKH CRORE
THE CAPEX
(CAPITAL
EXPENDITURE)
LEVEL TARGETED
BY THE
GOVERNMENT
IN THE JULY-
SEPTEMBER
QUARTER OF
2022; THIS IS 60
PER CENT OF THE
ANNUAL TARGET
OF ₹7.5 LAKH
CRORE IN FY23**



IN THE BLINK OF AN EYE

Users in India can get the recently-launched iPhone 14 delivered at their doorsteps in just minutes on quick-commerce platform Blinkit. In a tweet, Albinder Dhindsa, Co-founder and CEO of the Zomato-owned company, said it has partnered with Apple reseller Unicorn Infosolutions to make this possible. The partnership marks the debut for Apple products on a quick commerce platform in India.

—BINU PAUL

EVERYBODY WANTS THE iPhone

WITH THE WORLD looking at a resilient supply chain and seriously working towards the China-Plus-One strategy, India's most prominent business houses, too, are eyeing this opportunity to manufacture iPhones in India. The Tata group has been in talks with Apple's contract manufacturer Wistron for some time. And now Vedanta Group, which has entered into a joint venture with Foxconn, also wants to manufacture iPhones locally. However, both will require a go-ahead from Apple to start with.

—NIDHI SINGAL